MARKET SCREEN

Where Should We Build?

A category-level investment screen of 8,782 live micro-SaaS and app startups, ranked to identify where the next build should go.

8,782	31	117	$247.0M
STARTUPS SCREENED	APP CATEGORIES	COUNTRIES	COMBINED 12-MO REVENUE

Prepared for Product Strategy · August 2026

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Key takeaways

8,782	$247.0M	646,933	1.9x
Live startups analyzed	Trailing 12-mo revenue, combined	Active paid subscriptions	Median revenue multiple (for-sale listings)

1 AI is the most validated, but most commoditized

1,430 AI startups generate $25.6M in trailing revenue but the largest pool of proof-of-demand in the dataset. But median domain rating is just 5 and median revenue multiple is 2.0x, signalling low differentiation and thin acquirer appetite. Scale exists; defensibility mostly doesn't yet.

2 No-Code is small but the highest-quality niche

Only 41 No-Code startups exist, yet they carry the highest median revenue multiple in the dataset (4.2x) and strong domain authority (median DR 20) which means it is a scarce, defensible niche rather than a crowded one.

3 The US anchors every category; India is the #2 build hub

The US supplies ~24% of all startups and is the top country in every single category. India is consistently the #2 hub in Dev Tools, SaaS, Content Creation and Marketing and is most relevant for go-to-market and talent sourcing.

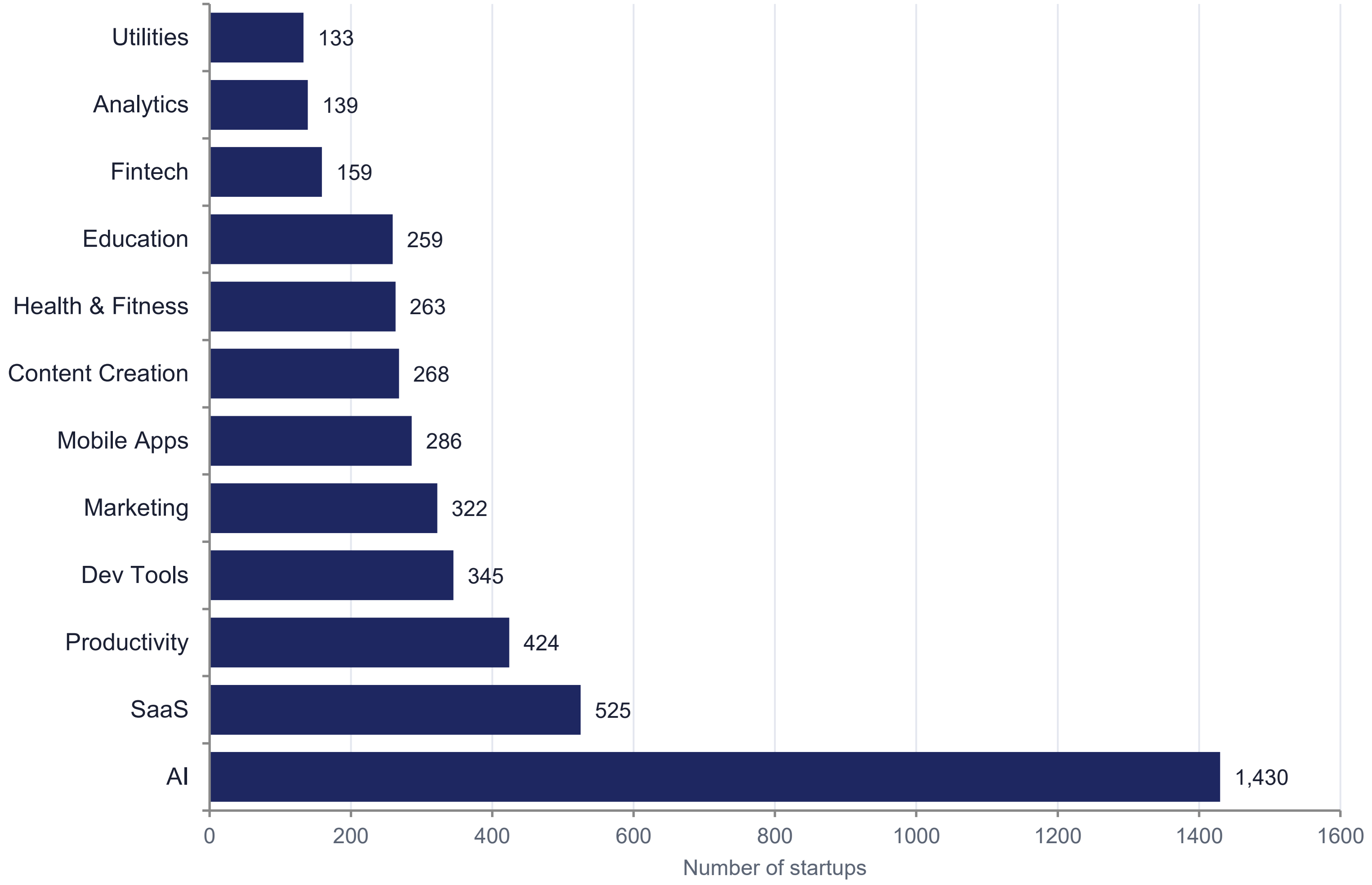
4 Stripe is the default rail; RevenueCat owns mobile-native

59% of startups run on Stripe. RevenueCat (14%) dominates specifically in Mobile Apps and Health & Fitness (71–85% share) and the clearest signal for choosing a billing stack by category.

Source: TrustMRR Full Dataset, n = 8,782

MARKET LANDSCAPE

Category density: where founders are already building



KEY TAKEAWAYS

AI is 2.7x the size of the #2 category (SaaS) — the clearest validated demand signal in the whole dataset.

Productivity, Dev Tools and Mobile Apps round out a crowded top tier — all north of 280 live startups.

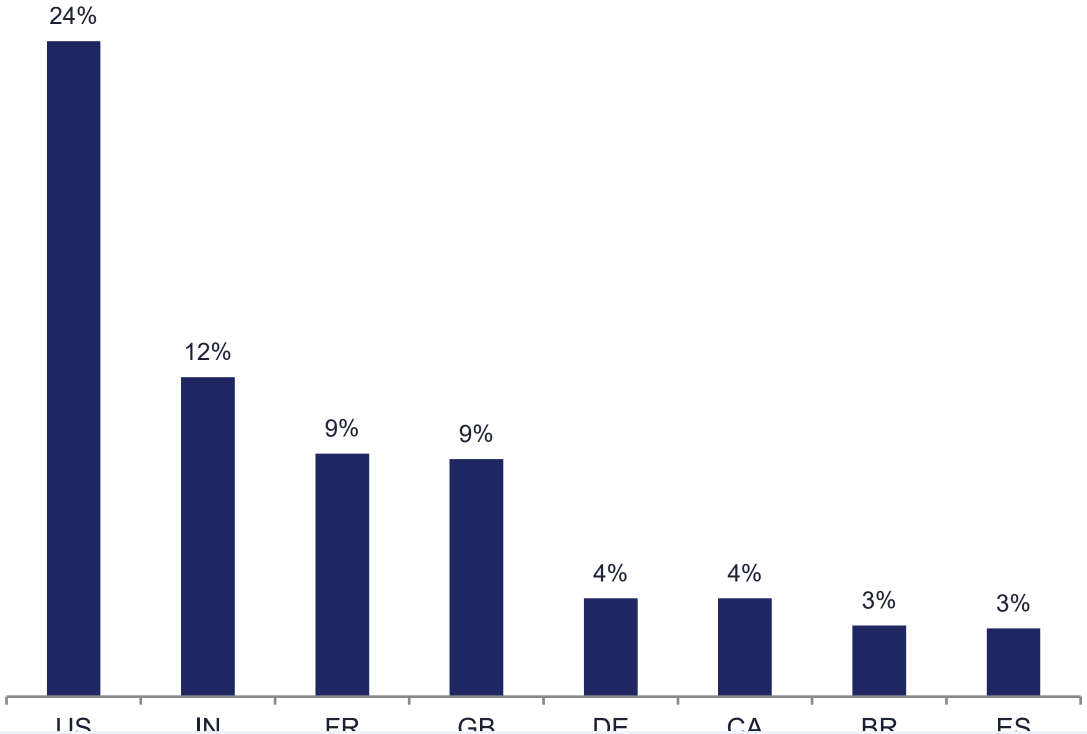
Volume alone isn't opportunity — it's demand validation. Pair this with the profitability and multiple data on the following slides before picking a category.

Source: TrustMRR Full Dataset · category field populated for 5,518 of 8,782 records

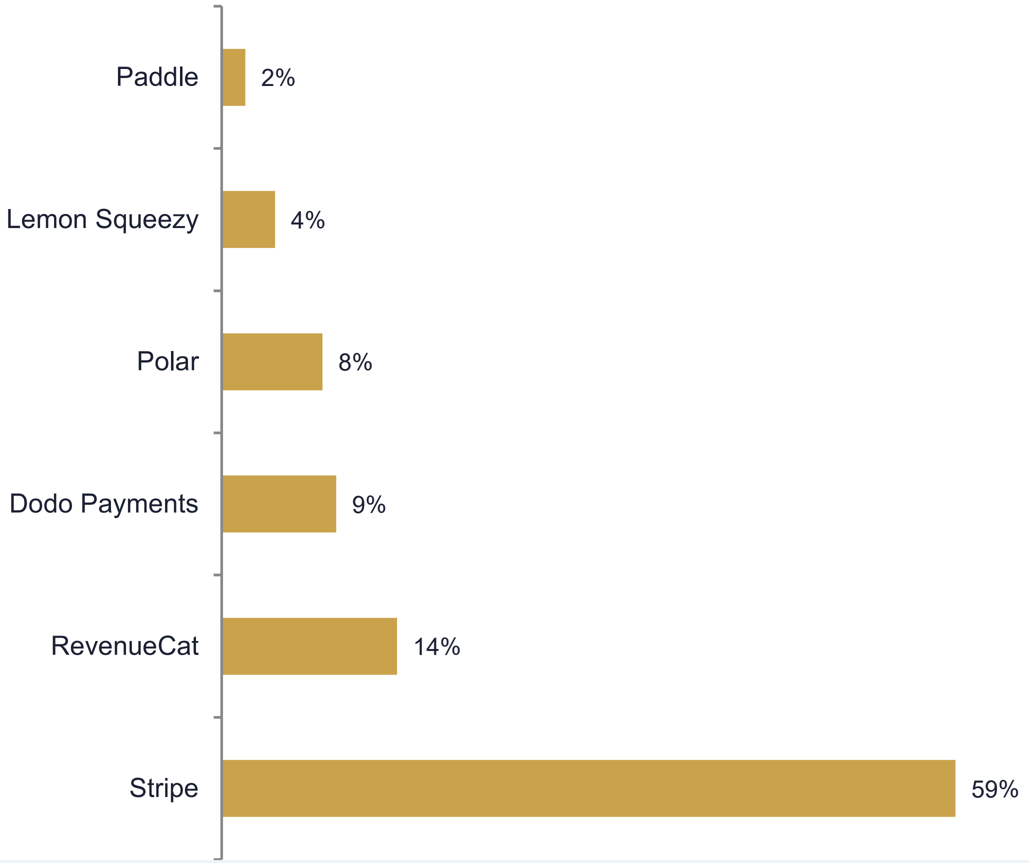
MARKET ACCESS

Where startups are beings Sold, and how they get paid

TOP COUNTRIES BY STARTUP SHARE



PAYMENT PROVIDER MIX

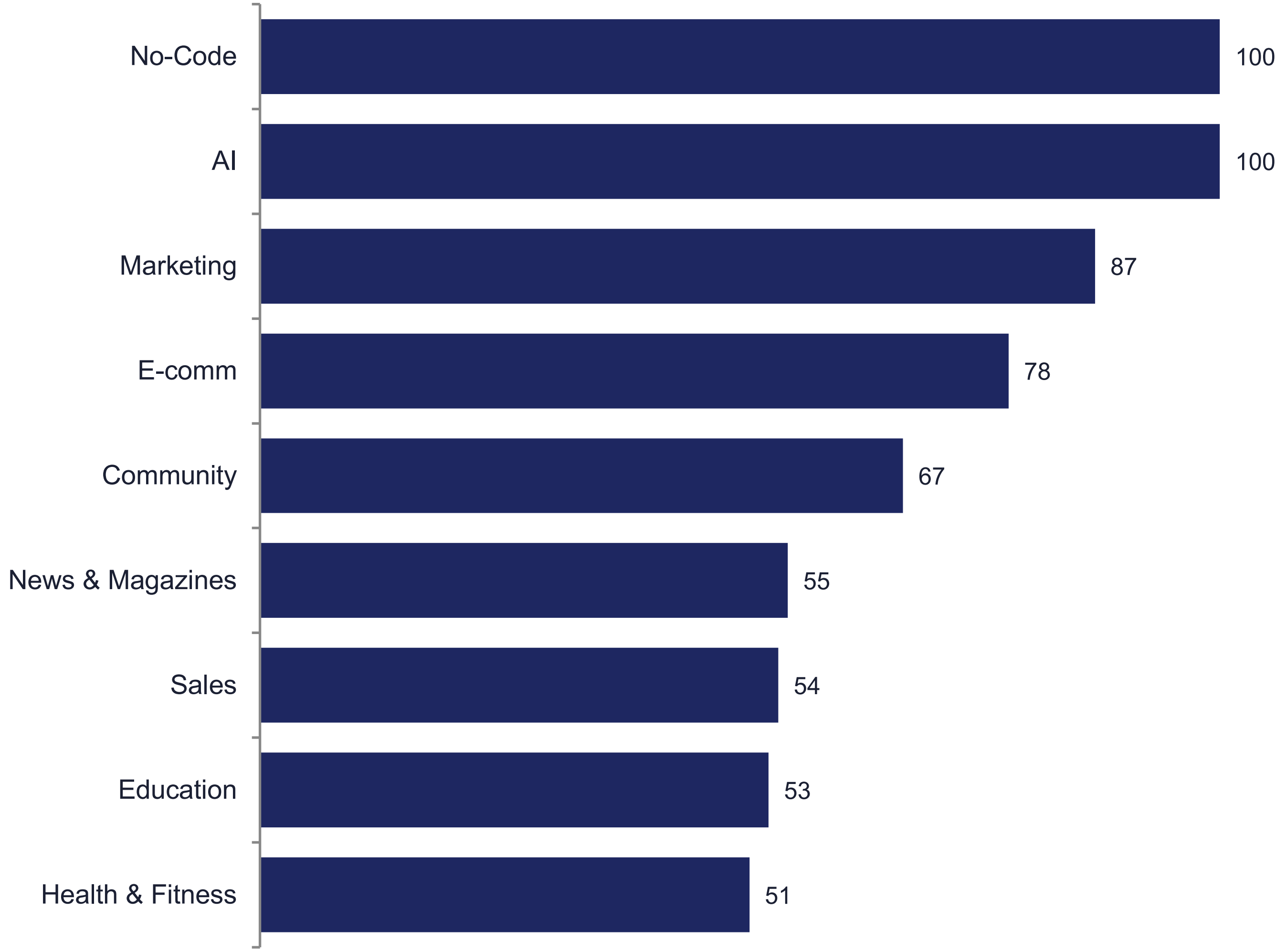


Takeaway: Build for the US first, localize for India second. Default to Stripe for web/B2B billing; use RevenueCat if the product is a mobile-native subscription app.

Source: TrustMRR Full Dataset · country populated for 6,913 of 8,782 records

OPPORTUNITY SCREEN

Ranking categories like a portfolio, not a popularity contest



METHODOLOGY

A weighted composite score (0–100), built per category from:

30% **Total trailing 12-mo revenue**
market size, proven

20% **Median revenue per startup**
unit economics

20% **Median revenue multiple**
acquirer / exit appetite

15% **Median domain rating**
organic / SEO moat

15% **Total active subscriptions**
retention depth

-10% **Startup count (competition)**
crowding penalty

Categories with fewer than 15 listed startups were excluded as statistically unreliable.

Score is relative within this dataset, not an absolute market-size forecast

SHORTLIST

Five categories worth a build memo

Category	Score /100	# Startups	Median 12-mo Rev.	Median Multiple	Median DR	Top Country	Billing Rail
No-Code	**100**	41	$1K	4.2x	20	US	Stripe
AI	100	1430	$0K	2.0x	5	US	Stripe
Marketing	87	322	$0K	1.6x	9	US	Stripe
E-comm	78	101	$1K	1.0x	7	US	Stripe
Community	67	41	$1K	3.3x	12	US	Stripe

★ *Highest composite score in the dataset*

WHY THIS SHORTLIST

No-Code and AI lead on very different profiles: No-Code is scarce and premium-valued (4.2x); AI is abundant and validated but commoditized (2.0x). **Marketing and E-comm** offer the best balance of scale and per-startup revenue. **Health & Fitness** stands out for subscription depth (58K+ active subs) via RevenueCat — a mobile-first consumer play.

Median 12-mo revenue used (not mean) to control for outlier startups like Gumroad, Stan

RECOMMENDATION

Build at the AI × No-Code intersection, sell to US SMBs on Stripe

01

Lead with AI, position like No-Code

Ride AI's proven demand (1,430 comps, $25.6M revenue) but price and package for the defensibility No-Code commands (4.2x multiple, DR 20) — a workflow/builder product, not a bare wrapper.

02

US-first GTM, India as expansion #2

The US is the top market in every category screened; India is the consistent runner-up across Dev Tools, SaaS and Marketing — sequence localization accordingly.

03

Default to Stripe; use RevenueCat only if mobile-native

59% of the market bills on Stripe. Only switch to RevenueCat if the product is a native mobile subscription app, where it holds 71–85% share.

04

Treat Marketing & E-comm tooling as a fallback bet

Both score in the top 4 with more startups (322 and 101) than No-Code, de-risking the bet if a pure AI-tools play proves too crowded.

Next step: build one-pager per shortlisted category with a costed MVP scope

APPENDIX

Data notes and caveats

1 Revenue is heavily right-skewed

Median trailing-12-month revenue across all startups is just $91; the mean is $28K, pulled up by outliers like Gumroad ($28.0M) and Stan ($25.0M). All category comparisons here use medians, not means.

2 37% of records have no category tag

3,264 of 8,782 startups carry no category label and were excluded from category-level analysis (base n = 5,518). Category-level conclusions should be read as directional, not exhaustive.

3 Revenue multiple only exists for for-sale listings

Only 1,952 startups (22%) are listed for sale with a disclosed multiple; multiples by category should be treated as an exit-appetite signal, not a valuation guarantee for the full market.

4 30-day growth figures are too noisy to rank on

Month-over-month revenue growth swings wildly at this sample size (e.g. single outliers move a category's average by hundreds of percentage points) and was excluded from the opportunity score for that reason.

Source: TrustMRR Full Dataset, frozen 30 Jul 2026